

SAP Crystal Reports for VS 2019

Installation Error 1304 – Step-by-Step Fix Guide

Error: Error 1304. Error writing to file: CrystalDecisions.VSDesigner.Mobile.resources.dll. Verify that you have access to that directory.

Installer: CRforVS13SP33_0-80007712.exe **Visual Studio:** 2019 Community 16.11.x

Checks already completed (ruled out)

- Controlled folder access is **Off**.
- No stale Crystal Reports entries in the Uninstall registry keys (normal and WOW6432Node).
- PendingFileRenameOperations does not exist.
- Windows Installer service re-registered (msiexec /unregister, /regserver).
- Visual Studio repaired; .NET desktop and ASP.NET workloads installed.
- No devenv.exe / ServiceHub processes running; temp files cleared; no third-party antivirus.
- Running from C:\Temp instead of the P: drive gave the same error.

Step 1 – Get a fresh installer (most likely fix)

- Search for **SAP Crystal Reports developer version for Microsoft Visual Studio** and open the official SAP download page.
- Download the **latest service pack (SP35 or newer)** instead of SP33, using Edge or Chrome directly (no download manager).
- Save it to a short path such as **C:\CRI** (no spaces).

Step 2 – Prepare the system

- Close Visual Studio and the Visual Studio Installer. Confirm in Task Manager that **devenv.exe**, **msbuild.exe** and **ServiceHub*** are not running.
- Make sure C: has at least **3 GB** free.
- Confirm **C:\Windows\Installer** exists and is not read-only.
- Right-click **C:\Program Files (x86)\Microsoft Visual Studio** > Properties > Security, and confirm your user has **Full control**.

Step 3 – Run the installer as administrator

- Right-click the new installer > **Run as administrator**.
- If Error 1304 appears, do **not** click Retry. Click Cancel and go to Step 4.

Step 4 – Run with logging to find the exact cause

Open Command Prompt as administrator and run (use your installer's real file name):

```
C:\CR\<installer_name>.exe /log C:\CR\cr.log
```

- Open **C:\CR\cr.log** in Notepad and press Ctrl+F.
- Search for **1304** and **return value 3**.
- Copy about 15 lines around the first match. This shows the exact folder the installer cannot write to.

Step 5 – Reset Windows Installer (if still failing)

```
net stop msiserver
msiexec /unregister
msiexec /regserver
net start msiserver
```

Note: if net stop says the service is not valid to stop, it simply was not running. That is fine.

Step 6 – Workaround without the designer installer

If the designer installer keeps failing, use the runtime through NuGet in your project (Package Manager Console):

```
Install-Package CrystalReports.Engine
```

Or install the **SAP Crystal Reports runtime engine for .NET Framework (64-bit)** from the same SAP page. You will not get the in-Visual-Studio report designer with this route.

Quick checklist

Done	Task
[]	Downloaded newer SP (35+) installer to C:\CR\
[]	Visual Studio and Installer fully closed
[]	C: drive has 3 GB+ free
[]	Ran installer as administrator
[]	If failed: generated cr.log and checked 1304 / return value 3
[]	If still failed: reset Windows Installer service and retried
[]	Fallback: installed runtime / NuGet package